



Juergen Gall

Stereo

MA-INF 2201 / MA-MOROB-M04
WS25/26

MA-INF 2206 - Seminar Vision



- First meeting: Tuesday, 3.2., 11:45
HS XVI, Nußallee 17
- Second meeting: Monday, 9.2., 11:45
2.025, Institute of Computer Science, Friedrich-Hirzebruch-Allee 8

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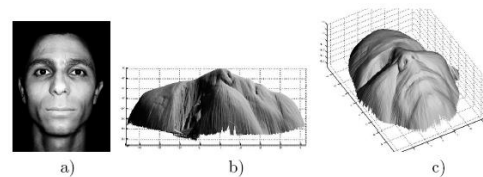
2

3D Reconstruction



What cues help us to perceive 3d shape and depth?

Shading



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Figure 10.10 (a)

3

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Figure 10.10 (b) & (c) (a)

4

Focus/defocus

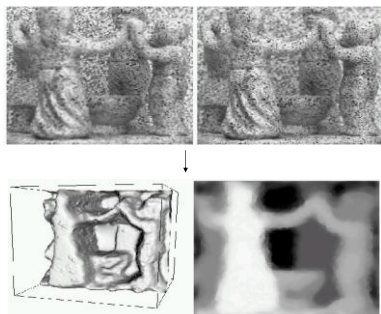
Images from
same point of
view, different
camera
parameters3d shape / depth
estimates

Figure 10.11 (a) and (b) (a)

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5

Motion



Figure 10.12 (a)

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Figure 10.12 (b) (a)

6

Estimating scene shape

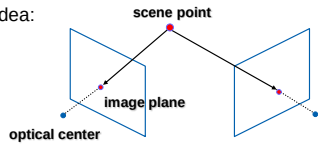
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“Shape from X”: Shading, Texture, Focus, Motion...

Stereo:

- shape from “motion” between two views
- infer 3d shape of scene from two (multiple) images from different viewpoints

Main idea:



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7



http://www.ssd.sri.com/~gongmin/occlusion_fix.html

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8

Stereo vision

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Two cameras, simultaneous views



Single moving camera and static scene

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Binocular stereo

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Given a calibrated binocular stereo pair, fuse it to produce a depth image



Dense depth map



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10

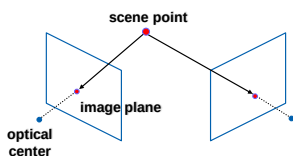
Estimating depth with stereo

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Stereo: shape from “motion” between two views

We'll need to consider:

- Info on camera pose (“calibration”)
- Image point correspondences



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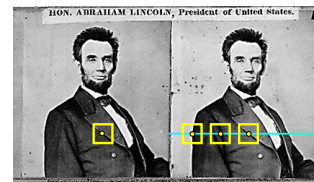
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11

Basic stereo matching algorithm

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- For each pixel in the first image
 - Find corresponding epipolar line in the right image
 - Examine all pixels on the epipolar line and pick the best match
 - Triangulate the matches to get depth information
- Simplest case: epipolar lines are scanlines

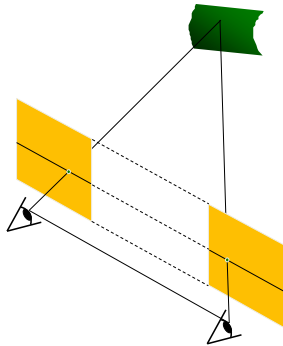
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12

Simplest Case: Parallel images



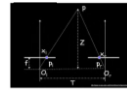
- Image planes of cameras are parallel to each other and to the baseline
- Camera centers are at same height
- Focal lengths are the same
- Then, epipolar lines fall along the horizontal scan lines of the images

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12

Recall: Essential matrix



$$\mathbf{R} = \mathbf{I}$$

$$\mathbf{T} = [-d, 0, 0]^T$$

$$\mathbf{E} = [\mathbf{T}]_s \mathbf{R} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & d \\ 0 & -d & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\mathbf{p} = [x, y, f]$$

$$\mathbf{p}' = [x', y', f]$$

$$\mathbf{p}'^T \mathbf{E} \mathbf{p} = 0$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} x' & y' & f \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & d \\ 0 & -d & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \\ f \end{bmatrix} = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \begin{bmatrix} x' & y' & f \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ df \\ -dy \end{bmatrix} = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow y = y'$$

For the parallel cameras, image of any point must lie on same horizontal line in each image plane.

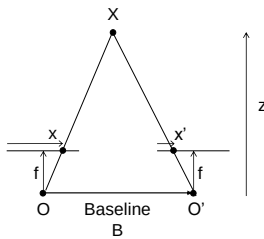
Wolfram Graumann

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13

Depth from disparity

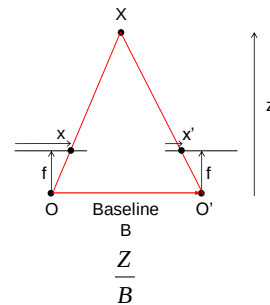


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14

Depth from disparity

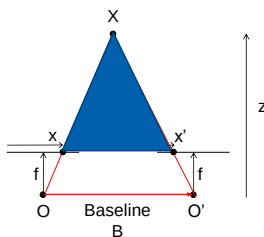


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15

Depth from disparity

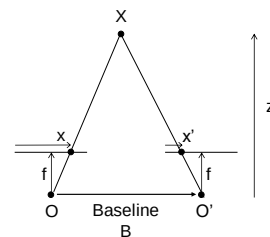


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17

Depth from disparity



$$disparity = x - x' = \frac{B \cdot f}{z}$$

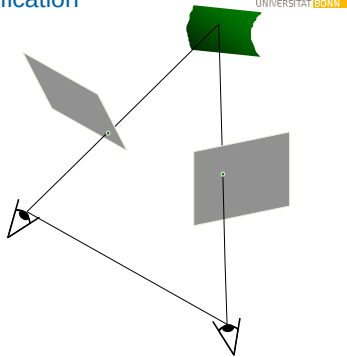
Disparity is inversely proportional to depth!

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18

Stereo image rectification



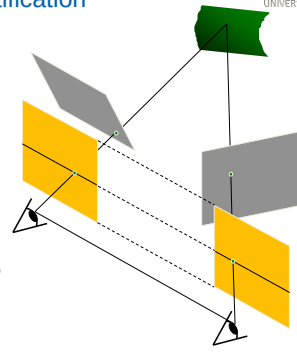
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Stereo image rectification

- Reproject image planes onto a common plane parallel to the line between optical centers
- Pixel motion is horizontal after this transformation
- Two homographies (3x3 transform), one for each input image reprojection
- C. Loop and Z. Zhang, Computing Rectifying Homographies for Stereo Vision, IEEE Conf. Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition, 1999.

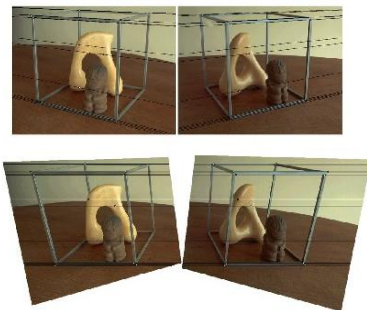


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20

Rectification example

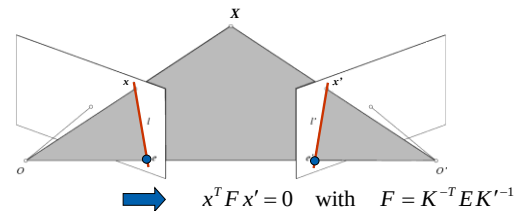


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Recall: Epipolar constraint



- $F x'$ is the epipolar line associated with x ($l = F x$)
- $F^T x$ is the epipolar line associated with x ($l' = F^T x$)
- $F e' = 0$ and $F^T e = 0$
- F is singular (rank two)
- F has seven degrees of freedom

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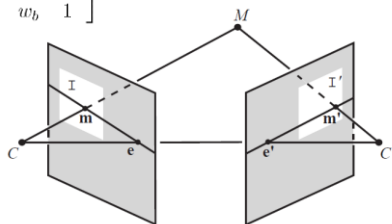
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22

Rectification

Estimate two homographies H and H'

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} u_a & u_b & u_c \\ v_a & v_b & v_c \\ w_a & w_b & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

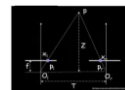


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Recall: Essential matrix



$$R = I$$

$$T = [-d, 0, 0]^T$$

$$E = [T]_x R = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & d \\ 0 & -d & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$p = [x, y, f]$$

$$p' = [x', y', f']$$

$$p'^T E p = 0$$

$$\begin{bmatrix} x' & y' & f' \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & d \\ 0 & -d & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \\ f \end{bmatrix} = 0$$

For the parallel cameras, image of any point must lie on same horizontal line in each image plane.

$$\Leftrightarrow \begin{bmatrix} x' & y' & f' \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ df \\ -dy \end{bmatrix} = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow y = y'$$

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24

Rectification



- Map epipoles to infinity (1,0,0) (canonical form)
- Fundamental matrix after rectification:

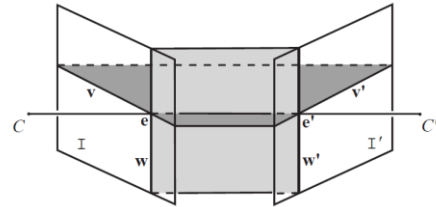
$$\bar{\mathbf{F}} = [\mathbf{i}]_{\times} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

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Rectification



$$\mathbf{H} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{u}^T \\ \mathbf{v}^T \\ \mathbf{w}^T \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} u_a & u_b & u_c \\ v_a & v_b & v_c \\ w_a & w_b & w_c \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\mathbf{H}\mathbf{e} = [\mathbf{u}^T\mathbf{e} \quad \mathbf{v}^T\mathbf{e} \quad \mathbf{w}^T\mathbf{e}]^T = [1 \quad 0 \quad 0]^T$$

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Decompose homography



- Decompose $\mathbf{H}$ into affine transformation $\mathbf{H}_a$ and projective transformation $\mathbf{H}_p$
- Decompose affine trans. $\mathbf{H}_a$ into similarity trans. $\mathbf{H}_s$ and shearing trans. $\mathbf{H}_r$
- $\mathbf{H} = \mathbf{H}_a\mathbf{H}_p = \mathbf{H}_s\mathbf{H}_r\mathbf{H}_p$

$$\mathbf{H}_s = \begin{bmatrix} s_a & s_b & s_c \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\mathbf{H}_r = \begin{bmatrix} v_b - v_c w_b & v_c w_a - v_a & 0 \\ v_a - v_c w_a & v_b - v_c w_b & v_c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{H}_p = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ w_a & w_b & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

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27

Rectification example

 $\mathbf{H}_p$

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28

Rectification example

 $\mathbf{H}_p$  $\mathbf{H}_r\mathbf{H}_p$

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29

Rectification example

 $\mathbf{H}_s\mathbf{H}_p$  $\mathbf{H}_s\mathbf{H}_r\mathbf{H}_p$

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30

Estimate projective transformation



- Estimate $\mathbf{H}_p$:
$$\mathbf{H}_p = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ w_a & w_b & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$
- All pixels from images $\mathbf{p}_i = [p_{i,u} \ p_{i,v} \ 1]^T$ are mapped by $\mathbf{H}_p$ with homogenous component: $w_i = \mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{p}_i$
- After rectification, the homogenous component should be the same for all points including the mean:

$$\mathbf{p}_c = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \mathbf{p}_i$$

- Minimize non-affine distortion:
$$\sum_{i=1}^n \left[\frac{\mathbf{w}^T (\mathbf{p}_i - \mathbf{p}_c)}{\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{p}_c} \right]^2$$
 (is zero for affine transformation)

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Estimate projective transformation



- Estimate $\mathbf{H}_p$:
$$\mathbf{H}_p = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ w_a & w_b & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$
- All pixels from images
$$\mathbf{P} = \begin{bmatrix} p_{1,u} - p_{c,u} & p_{2,u} - p_{c,u} & \dots & p_{n,u} - p_{c,u} \\ p_{1,v} - p_{c,v} & p_{2,v} - p_{c,v} & \dots & p_{n,v} - p_{c,v} \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & 0 \end{bmatrix} \mathbf{p}_c = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \mathbf{p}_i$$
- Minimize:
$$\frac{\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{P} \mathbf{P}^T \mathbf{w}}{\mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{p}_c \mathbf{p}_c^T \mathbf{w}}$$
- Relation:
$$\mathbf{w} = [\mathbf{e}]_{\times} \mathbf{z}$$

$$\mathbf{w}' = \mathbf{F} \mathbf{z}$$

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22

Estimate projective transformation



- Estimate $\mathbf{H}_p$:
$$\mathbf{H}_p = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ w_a & w_b & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$
- All pixels from images
$$\mathbf{P} = \begin{bmatrix} p_{1,u} - p_{c,u} & p_{2,u} - p_{c,u} & \dots & p_{n,u} - p_{c,u} \\ p_{1,v} - p_{c,v} & p_{2,v} - p_{c,v} & \dots & p_{n,v} - p_{c,v} \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & 0 \end{bmatrix} \mathbf{p}_c = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \mathbf{p}_i$$
- Minimize:
$$\frac{\mathbf{z}^T \underbrace{[\mathbf{e}]^T \mathbf{P} \mathbf{P}^T [\mathbf{e}]}_{\mathbf{A}} \mathbf{z}}{\mathbf{z}^T \underbrace{[\mathbf{e}]^T \mathbf{p}_c \mathbf{p}_c^T [\mathbf{e}]}_{\mathbf{B}} \mathbf{z}} + \frac{\mathbf{z}^T \underbrace{\mathbf{F}^T \mathbf{P}^T \mathbf{P}^T \mathbf{F}}_{\mathbf{A}'} \mathbf{z}}{\mathbf{z}^T \underbrace{\mathbf{F}^T \mathbf{p}_c \mathbf{p}_c^T \mathbf{F}}_{\mathbf{B}'}} \mathbf{z} \quad \mathbf{w} = [\mathbf{e}]_{\times} \mathbf{z}$$

$$\mathbf{w}' = \mathbf{F} \mathbf{z}$$
- Cholesky decomposition: $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{D}^T \mathbf{D}$
- $\mathbf{y}$ is eigenvector with highest eigenvalue of $\mathbf{D}^{-T} \mathbf{B} \mathbf{D}^{-1}$
- $\mathbf{w}$ and $\mathbf{w}'$ is given by $\mathbf{w} = [\mathbf{e}]_{\times} \mathbf{z} \quad \mathbf{w}' = \mathbf{F} \mathbf{z} \quad \mathbf{z} = \mathbf{D}^{-1} \mathbf{y}$

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Rectification example

 $\mathbf{H}_p$

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Estimate similarity transformation



- We know fundamental matrix $\mathbf{F}$ and

$$\mathbf{H}_p = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ w_a & w_b & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

- Similarity matrix is then given by

$$\mathbf{H}_r = \begin{bmatrix} F_{32} - w_a F_{33} & w_a F_{33} - F_{31} & 0 \\ F_{31} - w_a F_{33} & F_{32} - w_b F_{33} & F_{33} + v'_c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

- v'_c is set such that pixels (v) start with zero

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25

Rectification example

 $\mathbf{H}_p$  $\mathbf{H}_r \mathbf{H}_p$

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26

Map image back to image size



- Homographies $\mathbf{H}_r, \mathbf{H}_p$ rectify images, but might introduce unnecessary distortion, e.g., images are very small or very large.
- Map images back to original size (shearing):

$$\mathbf{S} = \begin{bmatrix} a & b & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

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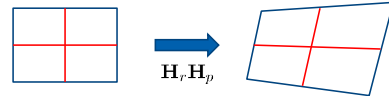
Map image back to image size



- Define reference lines:

$$\mathbf{a} = [\frac{w-1}{2} \ 0 \ 1]^T, \mathbf{b} = [w-1 \ \frac{h-1}{2} \ 1]^T, \mathbf{c} = [\frac{w-1}{2} \ h-1 \ 1]^T, \text{ and } \mathbf{d} = [0 \ \frac{h-1}{2} \ 1]^T$$

$$\hat{\mathbf{a}} = \mathbf{H}_r \mathbf{H}_p \mathbf{a} \quad \begin{matrix} \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b} - \mathbf{d} \\ \mathbf{y} = \mathbf{c} - \mathbf{a} \end{matrix}$$



- Make lines perpendicular and keep width and height ratio:

$$(\mathbf{Sx})^T (\mathbf{Sy}) = 0, \quad \frac{(\mathbf{Sx})^T (\mathbf{Sx})}{(\mathbf{Sy})^T (\mathbf{Sy})} = \frac{w^2}{h^2}.$$

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28

Map image back to image size



- Map images back to original size (shearing):

$$\mathbf{S} = \begin{bmatrix} a & b & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$a = \frac{h^2 x_v^2 + w^2 y_v^2}{hw(x_v y_u - x_u y_v)} \quad b = \frac{h^2 x_u x_v + w^2 y_u y_v}{hw(x_u y_v - x_v y_u)}$$

- Add translation and scale to preserve image area and pixels start at zero

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29

Rectification example

 $\mathbf{H}_p$

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30

Rectification example

 $\mathbf{H}_p$  $\mathbf{H}_r \mathbf{H}_p$

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31

Rectification example

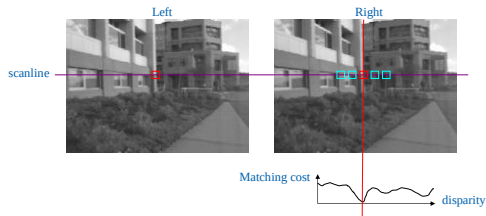
 $\mathbf{H}_r \mathbf{H}_p$  $\mathbf{H}_s \mathbf{H}_r \mathbf{H}_p$

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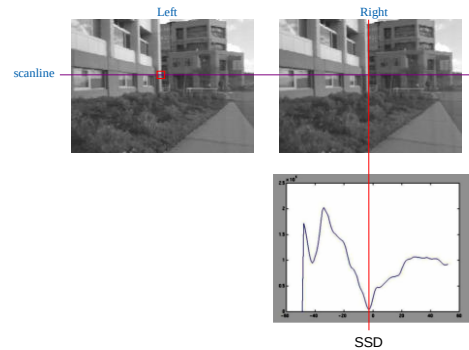
32

Correspondence search

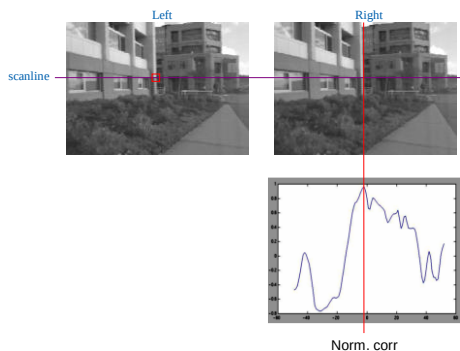


- Slide a window along the right scanline and compare contents of that window with the reference window in the left image
- Matching cost: SSD or normalized correlation

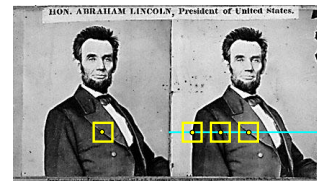
Correspondence search



Correspondence search

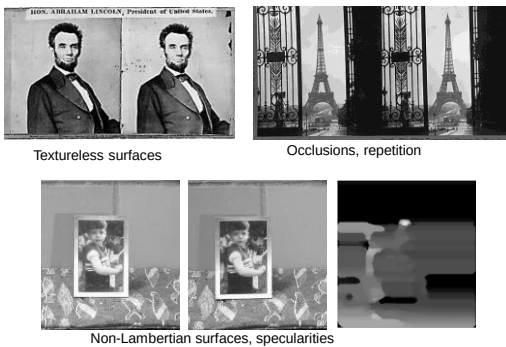


Basic stereo matching algorithm

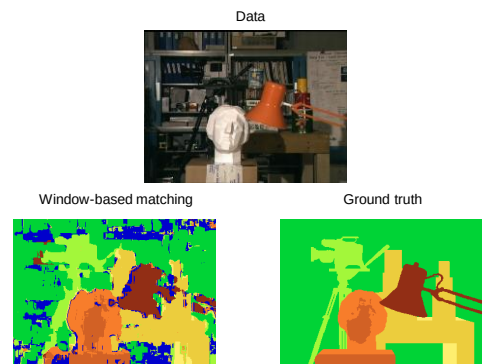


- If necessary, rectify the two stereo images to transform epipolar lines into scanlines
- For each pixel x in the first image
 - Find corresponding epipolar scanline in the right image
 - Examine all pixels on the scanline and pick the best match x'
 - Compute disparity $x - x'$ and set $\text{depth}(x) = B^*f/(x - x')$

Failures of correspondence search



Results with window search

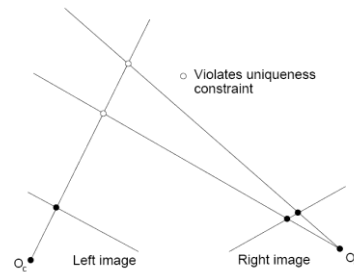


How can we improve window-based matching?

- The similarity constraint is local (each reference window is matched independently)
- Need to enforce some correspondence constraints

Non-local constraints

Uniqueness: For any point in one image, there should be at most one matching point in the other image



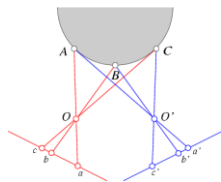
Non-local constraints

Uniqueness

- For any point in one image, there should be at most one matching point in the other image

Ordering

- Corresponding points should be in the same order in both views



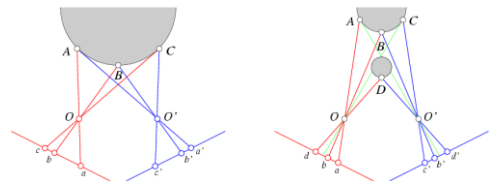
Non-local constraints

Uniqueness

- For any point in one image, there should be at most one matching point in the other image

Ordering

- Corresponding points should be in the same order in both views



Ordering constraint doesn't hold

Non-local constraints

Uniqueness

- For any point in one image, there should be at most one matching point in the other image

Ordering

- Corresponding points should be in the same order in both views

Smoothness

- We expect disparity values to change slowly (for the most part)

Scanline stereo

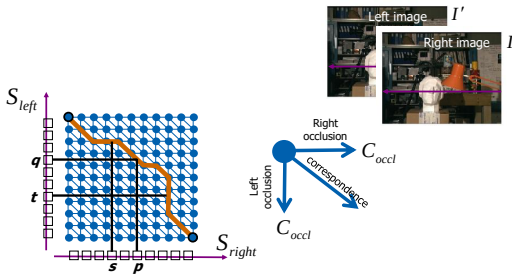
Try to coherently match pixels on the entire scanline

Different scanlines are still optimized independently



"Shortest paths" for scan-line stereo

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Can be implemented with dynamic programming
Ohta & Kanade '85, Cox et al. '96

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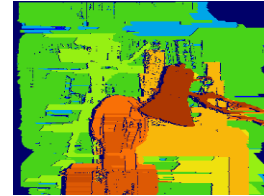
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Coherent stereo on 2D grid

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Scanline stereo generates streaking artifacts



Can't use dynamic programming to find spatially coherent disparities/ correspondences on a 2D grid

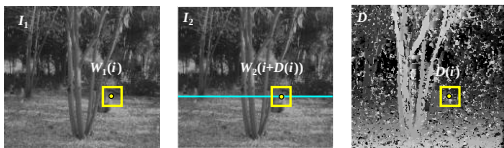
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Stereo matching as energy minimization

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$$E(D) = \underbrace{\sum_i (W_1(i) - W_2(i + D(i)))^2}_{\text{data term}} + \lambda \underbrace{\sum_{\text{neighbors } i,j} \rho(D(i) - D(j))}_{\text{smoothness term}}$$

Energy functions of this form can be minimized using graph cuts

Y. Boykov, O. Veksler, and R. Zabih, Fast Approximate Energy Minimization via Graph Cuts, PAMI 2001

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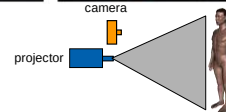
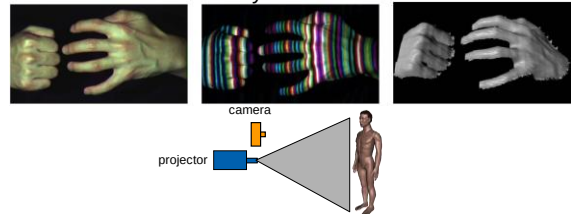
20

Active stereo with structured light

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Project "structured" light patterns onto the object

- Simplifies the correspondence problem
- Allows us to use only one camera



L. Zhang, B. Curless, and S. M. Seitz, Rapid Shape Acquisition Using Color Structured Light and Multi-pass Dynamic Programming, 3DPVT 2002

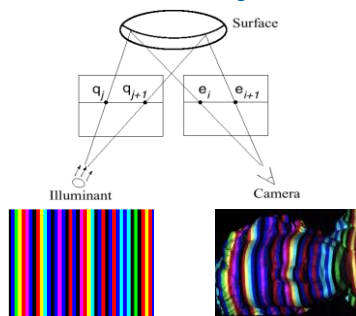
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Active stereo with structured light

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21

Aligning range images

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A single range scan is not sufficient to describe a complex surface
Need techniques to register multiple range images



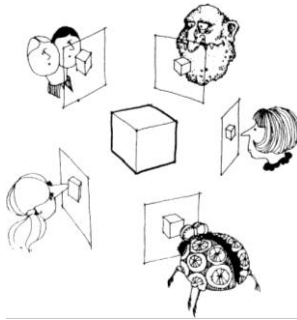
B. Curless and M. Levoy, A Volumetric Method for Building Complex Models from Range Images, SIGGRAPH 1996

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Multi-view stereo



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What is stereo vision?

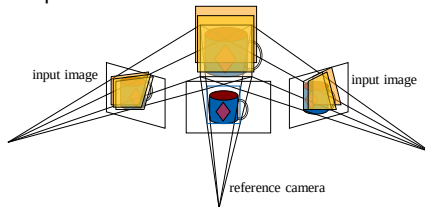
Generic problem formulation: given several images of the same object or scene, compute a representation of its 3D shape



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Plane Sweep Stereo

- Choose a reference view
- Sweep family of planes at different depths with respect to the reference camera



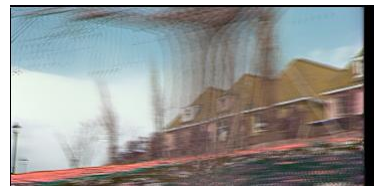
Each plane defines a homography warping each input image into the reference view

R. Collins. A space-sweep approach to true multi-image matching. CVPR 1996.

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Plane Sweep Stereo

- For each depth plane
 - For each pixel in the composite image stack, compute the variance



- For each pixel, select the depth that gives the lowest variance

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Plane Sweep Stereo

- For each depth plane
 - For each pixel in the composite image stack, compute the variance



- For each pixel, select the depth that gives the lowest variance
- Can be accelerated using graphics hardware

R. Yang and M. Pollefeys. Multi-Resolution Real-Time Stereo on Commodity Graphics Hardware, CVPR 2003

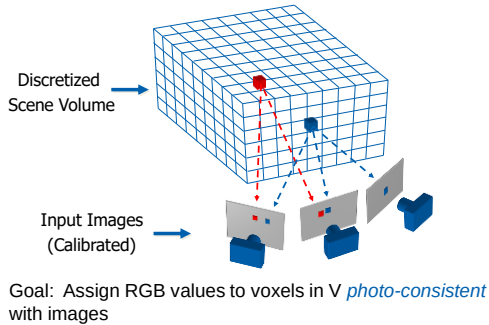
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Volumetric Stereo

- In plane sweep stereo, the sampling of the scene depends on the reference view
- We can use a voxel volume to get a view-independent representation

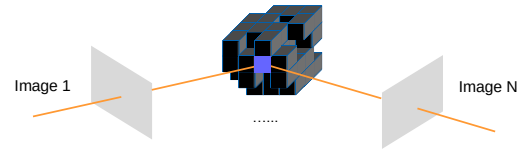
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Volumetric Stereo / Voxel Coloring



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Space Carving



Space Carving Algorithm

- Initialize to a volume V containing the true scene
- Choose a voxel on the outside of the volume
- Project to visible input images
- Carve if not photo-consistent
- Repeat until convergence

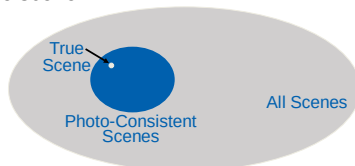
K. N. Kutulakos and S. M. Seitz, *A Theory of Shape by Space Carving*, ICCV 1999

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Photo-consistency

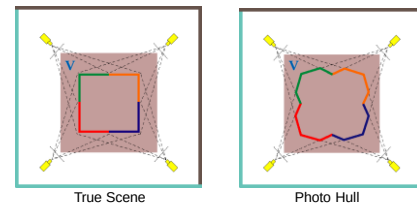


- A photo-consistent scene is a scene that exactly reproduces your input images from the same camera viewpoints
- You can't use your input cameras and images to tell the difference between a photo-consistent scene and the true scene



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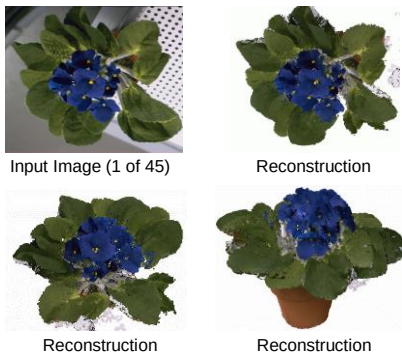
Which shape do you get?



- The **Photo Hull** is the UNION of all photo-consistent scenes in V
 - It is a photo-consistent scene reconstruction
 - Tightest possible bound on the true scene

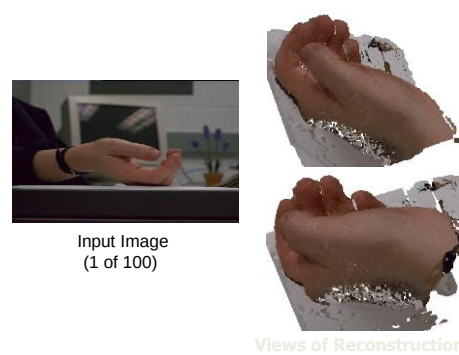
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Space Carving Results: African Violet



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Space Carving Results: Hand

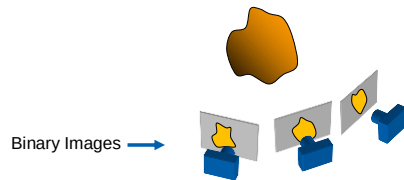


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Reconstruction from Silhouettes

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- The case of binary images: a voxel is photo-consistent if it lies inside the object's silhouette in all views



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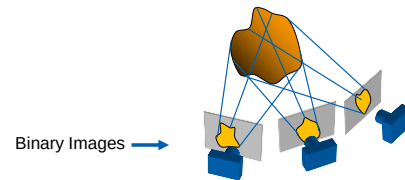
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72

Reconstruction from Silhouettes

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- The case of binary images: a voxel is photo-consistent if it lies inside the object's silhouette in all views



Finding the silhouette-consistent shape (*visual hull*):

- Backproject each silhouette
- Intersect backprojected volumes

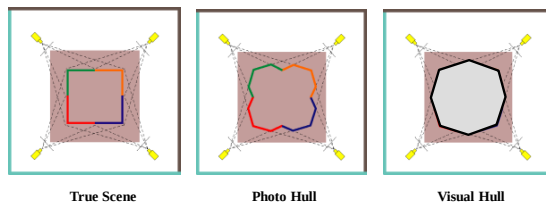
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Photo-consistency vs. silhouette-consistency

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True Scene

Photo Hull

Visual Hull

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74

Carved visual hulls

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- Compute visual hull
- Use dynamic programming to find rims and constrain them to be fixed
- Carve the visual hull to optimize photo-consistency



Yasutaka Furukawa and Jean Ponce, **Carved Visual Hulls for Image-Based Modeling**, ECCV 2006.

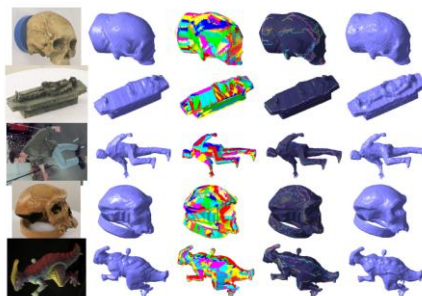
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75

Carved visual hulls

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Yasutaka Furukawa and Jean Ponce, **Carved Visual Hulls for Image-Based Modeling**, ECCV 2006.

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Carved visual hulls: Pros and cons

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- Pros
 - Visual hull gives a reasonable initial mesh that can be iteratively deformed
- Cons
 - Need silhouette extraction
 - Have to compute a lot of points that don't lie on the object
 - Finding rims is difficult
 - The carving step can get caught in local minima
- Possible solution: use sparse feature correspondences as initialization

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From feature matching to dense stereo

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1. Extract features
2. Get a sparse set of initial matches
3. Iteratively expand matches to nearby locations
4. Use visibility constraints to filter out false matches
5. Perform surface reconstruction



Yasutaka Furukawa and Jean Ponce, **Accurate, Dense, and Robust Multi-View Stereopsis**, CVPR 2007.

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79

From feature matching to dense stereo

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Yasutaka Furukawa and Jean Ponce, **Accurate, Dense, and Robust Multi-View Stereopsis**, CVPR 2007.

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80

Towards Internet-Scale Multi-View Stereo

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Yasutaka Furukawa, Brian Curless, Steven M. Seitz and Richard Szeliski, **Towards Internet-scale Multi-view Stereo**, CVPR 2010.

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Fast stereo for Internet photo collections

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- Start with a cluster of registered views
- Obtain a depth map for every view using plane sweeping stereo with normalized cross-correlation



Frahm et al. **Building Rome on a Cloudless Day**, ECCV 2010.

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Plane sweeping stereo

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- Need to register individual depth maps into a single 3D model
- Problem: depth maps are very noisy



Frahm et al. **Building Rome on a Cloudless Day**, ECCV 2010.

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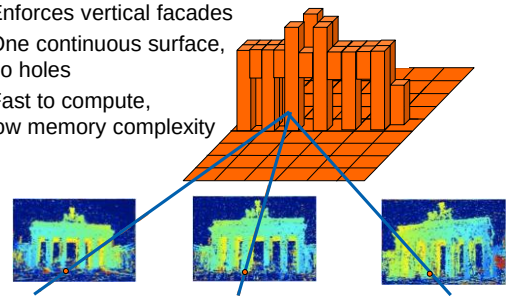
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Robust stereo fusion using a heightmap

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- Enforces vertical facades
- One continuous surface, no holes
- Fast to compute, low memory complexity



David Gallup, Marc Pollefeys, Jan-Michael Frahm, **"3D Reconstruction using an n-Layer Heightmap"**, DAGM 2010

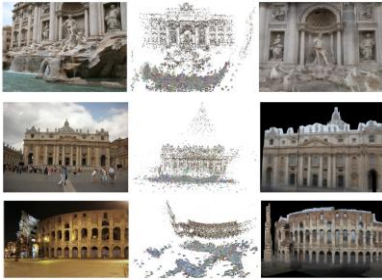
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84

Results

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Frahm et al., "Building Rome on a Cloudless Day," ECCV 2010.

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Results

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Reconstruction with CNNs (CV-II)

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Mengqi et al., "SurfaceNet: An End-to-end 3D Neural Network for Multiview Stereopsis" ICCV 2017.

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12



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13